UD26 UNIVERSAL DESIGN

Benchmarking Accessibility, Usability, and Universal Design

– What Kind of Society Are We Building?

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Agenda

- Purpose and Research Questions
- Introduce the Positive Peace Index
- Define Accessibility, Usability, and Universal Design
- Introducing the AUUD Matrix, plus some early results
- Conclusion
- Welcome to workshop tomorrow!

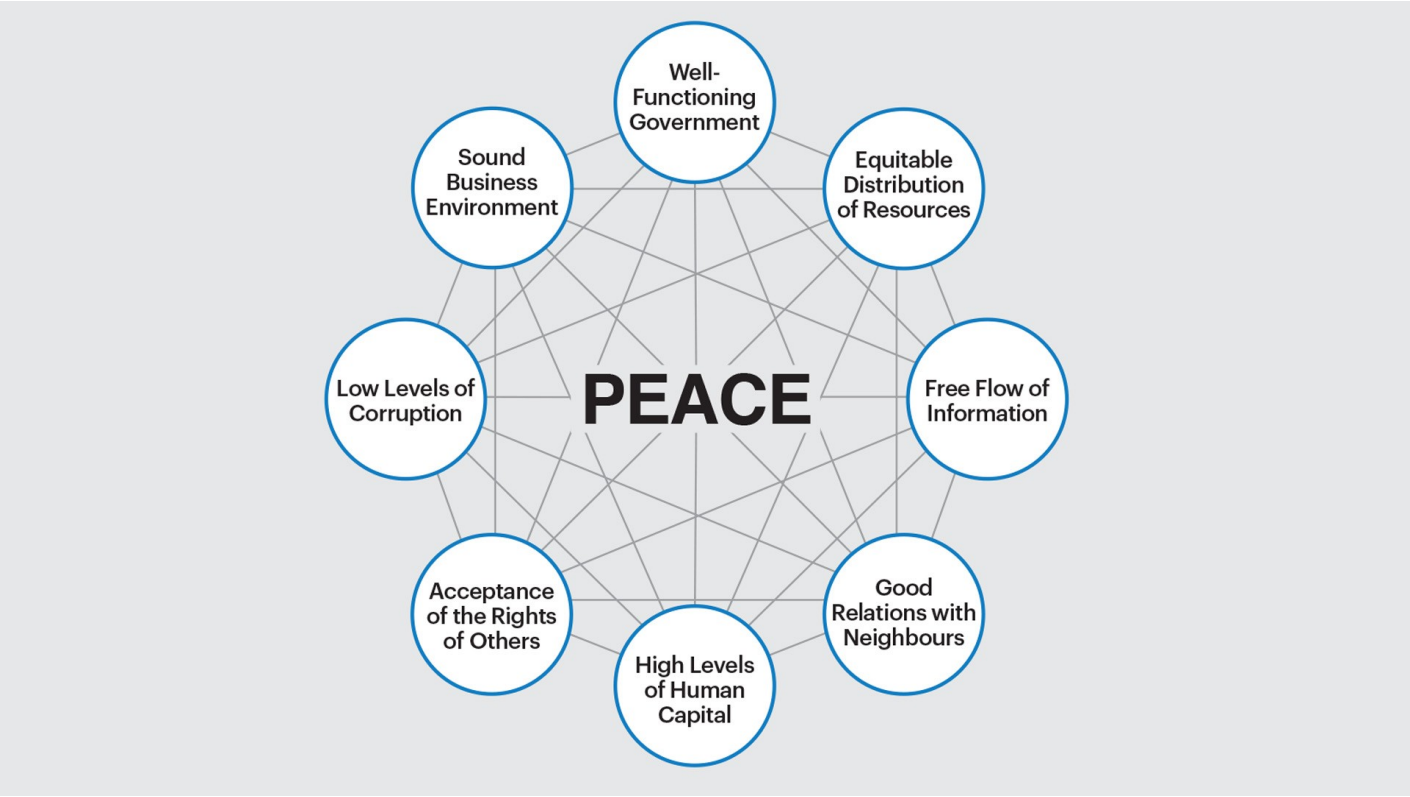
Do we measure what we value?

... to contribute to the UD evaluation discussion by unburdening UD from compliance and instead following UD on its own terms, focusing on the profound question:
“What kind of society are we building?”

Purpose and Research Questions

1. How can accessibility, usability and UD be evaluated together?
2. How can UD be evaluated on its own terms?

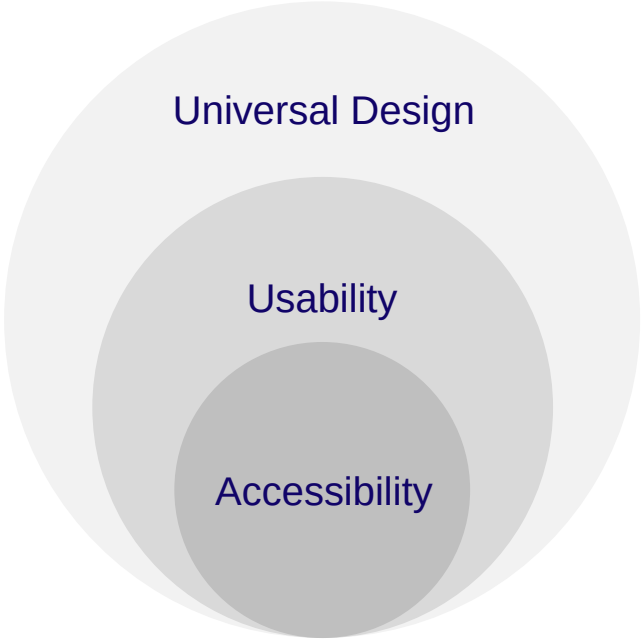
The Positive Peace Index, PPI



Source: Vision of Humanity, The eight pillars of Positive Peace (visionofhumanity.org)

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Accessibility, Usability and Universal Design: ingredients that are part of a totality



- Equity and Equality
- Non-stigmatization
- Intersectionality

- Effectiveness
- Efficiency
- Satisfaction

- Access

Conditions for Participation

(Hedvall, Ståhl and Iwarsson, 2025)

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The Accessibility, Usability, and Universal Design (AUUD) Matrix

	Accessibility	Usability	Universal Design
Output			
Process			
Societal impact			

Societal Impact * Universal Design

- **Full participation; Flexibility** (alternatives and choices);
- **Questions (**"what is a city for all?", “what does UD contribute to?” "where do we actually know anything?", “how good is this environment?”);
- **Concepts** (spatial capital, the three pillars, the digital democratic twin, "for more people, not more stuff"); **instruments** (citizen surveys, social sustainability accounting, a national public-health survey);
- **Socio-economic analysis; policy development** (public-health goals ignore the physical environment);
- **Trust** in others, **agency**; democratic **participation**, **interaction**; **organisational development**.

What would you evaluate regarding UD?

A field that refuses to benchmark what it values ends up valuing what it can benchmark.
What would you follow over time regarding Universal Design's Societal Impact? Come and contribute to our workshop tomorrow afternoon: "What Makes Universal Design Visible? A Workshop on Direct and Proxy Indicators"

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Thank You!

We hope to see you at the workshop tomorrow!

Questions?